



Ola gets a billion in funding

Ride-hailing company Ola has raised \$1.1 billion (Rs7,180 crore) in a funding round led by Chinese internet giant Tencent <http://dgit.in/OlaBillion>



Drone hits plane in Canada

A small drone struck a passenger jet recently in the first incident of its kind in Canada. The plane suffered minor damage and landed safely. <http://dgit.in/DronCrash>

on the left in mind, it's going to be a very VERY expensive change to implement. And it's not like people have tons of trouble when they visit other countries.

DATE NOTATION

A small fry compared to measurements but just as annoying – Americans writing the date as MM/DD/YYYY compared to the 'regular' way of DD/MM/YYYY. And interestingly enough, no one exactly knows why. A popular theory however, is that all English speaking nations actually used to follow the MM/DD/YYYY format as this how you would normally talk about a date. For example, you might say "I will be com-

why exactly this divide has occurred so all we can do is wonder.

PLUGS AND ELECTRICITY

Okay, America is not the only one to blame here. Around the world, there are about 12 different major socket types, although if you are a frequent traveller it might seem like every single country has its own type. And it's not that each socket is different, oh no. Some countries (read: America) even have a different voltage – 110V compared to the more common 220-240V. At least the socket problem can be remedied by an adaptor but if you end up plugging an appliance that was rated to run at 110V into

single appliance to get up to a 240V rating. And hence the voltage is 110V in America and Japan while it's 240V literally everywhere else.

Sockets are a different story, albeit just as simple. Countries really weren't thinking of the big picture when they set their engineers to setting up the electrical grids. Therefore, different ideas for plugs evolved throughout the world and they got implemented in their own countries. The idea that a traveller going abroad might need to bring their device with them was a preposterous idea! Who in their right minds would carry their fridge along with them on a cruise!??? By the time the need came for foreign travellers to actually need to use their own appliances with an international socket, the population was humongous and billions of sockets had to be replaced which made it an unfeasible idea. So unfortunately, we have to make to do with adaptors.



The countries highlighted in yellow are the only ones that still drive on the left

ing on November 14th." But interestingly enough, countries like England changed their notation to the DD/MM/YYYY around the time written communication was on the rise (closely coinciding with the printing press going mainstream). This was perhaps because that's how you would formally write down a date – "On the 14th of November, yada yada yada". But America never made this switch. Another popular theory is that due to the Industrial Revolution making accounting essential for the blooming American industries, it was easier to use the MM/DD format just to make sorting easier – you could easily segregate transactions into monthly blocks and it made sense because it was in an ascending order. Only 12 choices for the first slot, 31 choices for the second slot and so on. But at the end of the day, no one really knows

a socket rated at 240V... Your appliance won't have a good time.

The first electrical grids all ran on 120V throughout the world, until a couple of decades later, scientists found out that there was way too much drop off in voltage across long distance transmission. This could be combated by pretty much doubling the amount of voltage to about 240V and thus this solution was recommended. At this time, the Industrial Revolution was in full swing in the Americas and the meteoric rise of the middle class meant that pretty much every household had a refrigerator and washing machine, while Europe being a little more rural, did not have such a prolific spread of appliances. So it was much easier for Europeans to upgrade their grid while it would've been financially ruining for Americans to replace every

SPELLINGS

Aha! Finally we can point a finger and blame a person entirely for something. Noah Webster, the guy who wrote the "Webster's Dictionary" is the reason Americans spell so differently. Noah decided that since America was the new and happening nation, they should also have enough differences in their version of English that was undoubtedly better than the stuffy old English of Great Britain. He was also a great fan of phonetic spelling and found it really weird that some words were pronounced much differently than how they were spelt. (We can thank French influence for that)

So he set about changing word spellings like dropping the o from words containing ou (Honor vs Honour, Color vs Colour), tried getting away with f instead of ph (Sulfur vs Sulphur) and mixed e and r positions (center vs centre, theater vs theatre). He collected all these words into his Dictionary and slowly, they came to be accepted as the de facto spellings for the words in America. The pronunciations also changed slightly due to this as well and thus the great divide between American and British English was born. 🇺🇸